

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: RESPONSIBLE EXECUTIVE AND CONSTITUTIONAL CHAIN

00. RESPONSIBLE EXECUTIVE AND CONSTITUTIONAL CHAIN

Article 74 creates PM-headed advice

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v

Article 75 creates responsibility to Lok Sabha

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v

Article 77 gives formal expression and business rules

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v

Article 78 preserves the information bridge

ANSWER LINE:

The President supplies constitutional form while the PM-led Council supplies politically responsible executive choice.

MUST REMEMBER: Reconstruct the responsible Union executive through Articles 74, 75, 77, 78 and 88: appointment, advice, confidence, responsibility, membership, business allocation and parliamentary participation are separate constitutional questions.

01. PRIME MINISTER APPOINTMENT, ELIGIBILITY AND CONFIDENCE

Clear majority narrows presidential choice

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v

Hung House requires objective support material

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v

Prompt floor test determines survival

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v

Article 75(5) allows only six consecutive months

ANSWER LINE:

Appointment begins government formation, but Lok Sabha confidence completes democratic authority.

02. PRIME MINISTER POWERS AND PRESIDENTIAL RELATION

Selects ministers and allocates portfolios

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v

Chairs Cabinet and coordinates policy

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v

Article 78 channels information to President

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v

Party and coalition arithmetic condition power

ANSWER LINE:

Prime-ministerial authority combines constitutional position with party leadership and remains conditional on confidence.

03. COUNCIL, CABINET, RANKS AND THE 91ST AMENDMENT

Council is the wider constitutional ministry

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v

Cabinet is the Cabinet-rank decision core

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v

Ranks are conventional, not a four-rank constitutional code

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v

Article 75(1A) uses total Lok Sabha membership

ANSWER LINE:

The 91st Amendment disciplines ministry size and defectors without fixing the actual size or ranks of the ministry.

04. COLLECTIVE, INDIVIDUAL AND LEGAL RESPONSIBILITY

Article 75(3): ministry stands or falls together

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v

Article 75(2): PM enforces individual exit

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v

Cabinet solidarity requires public defence or resignation

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v

No universal countersignature does not erase ordinary liability

ANSWER LINE:

Responsibility is strongest when confidence, solidarity, personal discipline and legal accountability are kept distinct.

05. ARTICLE 77 AND GOVERNMENT BUSINESS

Allocation Rules answer who handles a subject

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v

Transaction Rules answer how important cases move

|
v

Defined cases escalate to PM, committees, Cabinet or President

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v

Authentication is not personal presidential decision

ANSWER LINE:

Article 77 turns political direction into traceable departmental action through allocation, consultation and escalation.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Keep Council of Ministers, Cabinet, Cabinet Committees, Cabinet Secretariat, PMO and kitchen cabinet distinct by source, membership, legal status and function; do not constitutionalise administrative or informal bodies.

06. CABINET COMMITTEES AND CURRENT CONTROL

Standing and ad hoc committees specialise Cabinet work

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v

Cabinet retains the collective-responsibility frame

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v

Number, membership and chairs vary by notification

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v

Official composition document is dated 27 July 2026

ANSWER LINE:

Cabinet Committees improve specialisation, but current composition must come from the dated official notification.

07. CABINET SECRETARIAT, PMO AND INFORMAL SUPPORT

Cabinet Secretariat administers business rules

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v

It records, coordinates and monitors Cabinet decisions

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v

PMO is non-constitutional staff support without independent competence

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v

Kitchen Cabinet and GoMs are informal or ad hoc mechanisms

ANSWER LINE:

Coordination bodies assist the formal executive but cannot replace ministerial competence or parliamentary responsibility.

08. CARETAKER, COALITION AND CONTINUITY

PM resignation or death ends the ministry politically

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v

Article 74 requires continuity until successor assumes office

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v

Coalition bargaining affects solidarity, not Article 75(3)

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v

Caretaker restraint is convention, not a separate constitutional code

ANSWER LINE:

Political arithmetic changes the intensity of PM power, while constitutional continuity and confidence remain constant.

09. PARLIAMENTARY ACCOUNTABILITY AND PRIME-MINISTERIAL GOVERNMENT

Question Hour, committees, finance and audit create scrutiny

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v

No-confidence supplies the collective sanction

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v

Whip and Tenth Schedule may compress legislative autonomy

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v

Courts, federalism, elections and Cabinet colleagues constrain dominance

ANSWER LINE:

India shows a prime-ministerial tendency within cabinet government, not a legal replacement of cabinet government.

10. PYQ AND PRELIMS TRAP ROUTES

Shamsher Singh (1974): responsible advice

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v

S.R. Chaudhuri (2001): no serial six-month appointments

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v

2024 GS-II Q3 asks how Cabinet growth marginalises scrutiny

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v

Article 88 gives participation, not a vote without membership

ANSWER LINE:

High-scoring responses identify the exact provision, reject frozen counts and separate Union rules from State analogues.

11. ANSWER EXECUTION, REFORM AND QUALIFIED VERDICT

10 marks: provision, mechanism, limitation, verdict

|

v

15 marks: add institutional chain and named evidence

|

v

20 marks: balance concentration against counterweights

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v

Reforms must target whip, scrutiny, PMO subsidiarity and traceability

ANSWER LINE:

Strong executive coordination earns constitutional legitimacy only when each decision remains traceable to collective responsibility.

LEGAL/SOURCE LIMIT: Use the current Prime Minister and the Cabinet Secretariat's Allocation of Business and Transaction of Business Rules only as dated official controls. Committee number, membership and chairmanship remain notification-sensitive.